

VS Code + Git + Terminal Cheat Sheet

VS Code Shortcuts

Command/Shortcut	Meaning / What it does
Cmd + S	Save current file
Cmd + N	Create new file
Cmd + O	Open file or folder
Cmd + P	Quickly open file by name
Cmd + Shift + P	Command palette (all VS Code commands)
Cmd + Shift + F	Search across entire project
Cmd + Option + S	Save all open files
Ctrl + `	Open/close terminal in VS Code
Cmd + B	Toggle sidebar
Cmd + W	Close current tab
Cmd + /	Comment/uncomment line

Terminal Basics

Command	Meaning / What it does
pwd	Shows current directory location
ls	Lists files and folders
ls -la	Lists all files including hidden ones
cd folder	Moves into a folder
cd ..	Moves one folder up
cd	Goes to home directory
mkdir name	Creates a new folder
touch file.txt	Creates a new file
clear	Clears terminal screen
open .	Opens current folder in Finder (Mac)

Git Basics (Version Control)

Command	Meaning / What it does
git status	Shows file changes and tracking status
git add .	Stages all changes for commit
git add file	Stages specific file
git commit -m "msg"	Saves snapshot with message
git push	Uploads changes to GitHub
git pull	Downloads latest changes from GitHub
git log	Shows commit history
git diff	Shows changes before commit
git remote -v	Shows GitHub connection URL
git init	Initializes Git repository
git clone URL	Copies repo from GitHub

Folder Management

Command	Meaning / What it does
mkdir folder	Creates a folder
mkdir A B C	Creates multiple folders
mv A B/	Moves folder A into folder B
mv old new	Renames file or folder
rm -r folder	Deletes folder and contents
rm file.txt	Deletes a file
cp file.txt folder/	Copies file into folder

Git Recovery (IMPORTANT SAFETY COMMANDS)

Command	Meaning / What it does
git restore file	Undo changes in file (before commit)
git reset --soft HEAD 1	Undo last commit (keep changes)
git reset --hard HEAD 1	Delete last commit completely
git checkout -- file	Revert file to last commit state
git stash	Temporarily save unfinished work
git stash pop	Restore stashed work

Daily Workflow (Recommended)

1. Save file (Cmd + S)
2. Check changes: `git status`
3. Stage changes: `git add .`
4. Commit changes: `git commit -m "message"`
5. Sync to GitHub: `git push`

Mental Model

Tool	Meaning
VS Code	Code editor where you write and edit files
Terminal	Direct control of computer via commands
Folder	Local project storage
Git	Version control system (history tracker)
GitHub	Cloud storage and collaboration platform
Repository	A project tracked by Git